

The University of Alabama's CrossingPoints Tier 3 program offers individuals with intellectual disabilities an opportunity to earn a Certificate of Occupational Studies at The University of Alabama (the "CCOS students"). CCOS students that have successfully completed one year of the CCOS program may choose to participate in the Alabama Interfraternity Council (IFC) recruitment process, and if they receive a bid, join a fraternity.

CCOS students participating in IFC recruitment and fraternity life do so independently of UA and the CrossingPoints program. As with other activities in which CCOS students participate that are outside of the CCOS program, the CrossingPoints program is unable to provide mentors or other supports to CCOS students during the recruitment process and, if they accept a bid, through their participation in fraternity life.

In order to help facilitate the **structured** recruitment process for CCOS students, the Alabama Interfraternity Council & Office of Fraternity and Sorority Life will:

- Assign a recruitment counselor specifically to any CCOS student(s) participating in IFC (structured) Recruitment.
- Help facilitate a meeting between CrossingPoints staff, OFSL staff, the CCOS student(s) and his family prior to the start of IFC Recruitment to discuss the IFC Recruitment experience and general membership expectations.

In order to provide general information to IFC chapters regarding the CrossingPoints program, a CrossingPoints staff member will:

- Meet with OFSL staff and representatives from all interested IFC chapters prior to the start of the recruitment period to provide general information regarding the CrossingPoints program.
- Meet with OFSL staff, members of IFC exec, and the designated recruitment counselor prior to IFC recruitment to provide general information that the chapters may want to consider when interacting with CCOS students. However, the CCOS student is responsible for informing the Chapter of any specific supports and reasonable accommodations he needs in order to participate in the recruitment process and/or fraternity life.
- Provide general information to the members and chapter supporters of any chapter that a CCOS student joins.

In the event a CCOS student accepts a bid and joins an IFC chapter, the chapter will:

- Be responsible for working with the CCOS student and his family to determine and implement any reasonable supports, accommodations, and/or modifications needed by the CCOS student in order to participate in the chapter's fraternity life.
- Identify five members to serve on the chapter's CrossingPoints Committee and to serve as supporters to the CCOS students. The chapter is responsible for setting the expectations for the these supports and defining the role they will play in assisting the CCOS students.
- Be responsible for any and all training and resources the chapter may deem necessary, in its sole discretion, for its members and/or chapter supporters.

- Discuss chapter membership expectations with the CCOS student and his family in the time frame between the time a bid is extended and the beginning of the IFC New Member Period.

The CCOS student(s) and her parents/guardians understand and agree as follows that:

- Participation in the IFC recruitment process and acceptance of a bid is voluntary and at the CCOS student's sole discretion.
- IFC chapters are private organizations that are neither owned nor operated by UA. As is true for all members, participation in the IFC Recruitment process and in any fraternity events falls outside the scope of UA and the CrossingPoints program. The CrossingPoints program is unable to provide mentors or other supports to CCOS students during the recruitment process and, if they accept a bid, through their participation in fraternity life.
- Each chapter has its own membership expectations including, but not limited to, a member's conduct on social media, representation of the chapter, attendance at meetings, maintenance of a specific GPA, etc.
- The CCOS student should work with the chapter to determine and implement any reasonable supports, accommodations, and/or modifications needed by the CCOS student to participate in the chapter's fraternity life.
- IFC recruitment is a process of mutual selection; as such, the CCOS student may or may not receive a bid.
- **Assumption of Risks:** Participation in fraternity life may include events at bars, pubs, restaurants, fraternity houses and other venues at which alcohol is available. Members are not required to participate in these events. The CCOS student and his parents/guardians should discuss expectations for his attendance at such events and, if the CCOS student chooses to attend, he, like other PNMs, voluntarily agrees to assume and accept all risks, which may include injury and/or death, in doing so. Likewise, the CCOS student and his parents/guardians understand and acknowledge that there are risks, including significant risks, in all activities that can result in loss, damage, injury, or death including, without limitation: activities related to recruitment; activities related to fraternity life; travel risks such as accidents, crashes and risks from the operation of motor vehicles operated by UA or other individuals or entities, poorly maintained streets, sidewalks, as well as other criminal acts that can result in serious injury or death; premises risks, including those that may be owned by others and risks from water, such as drowning; injury risks from falls, collisions, or accidents (such as cuts, bruises, torn muscles, sprains, broken bones, etc.); outdoor risks, such as weather, lightning, heat or cold, bites, stings, allergic reactions, dehydration, hypothermia, drowning, sunburn, animals, and limited access to medical care; risks from others involved in recruitment or Greek life (such as transmitted illnesses or others' actions); health risks, such as heart, respiratory or alcohol/drug-related events, and other risks and hazards beyond the control of UA or others. The CCOS student and his parents/guardian acknowledge that they have had an opportunity to investigate these risks before executing this form and, knowing and understanding all risks associated herewith, nevertheless agree to assume and accept

all risks that potentially accompany participation in IFC recruitment and fraternity life. The CCOS student agrees to take all reasonable steps to avoid any risks, injury, or death.

- **Waiver of Liability and Indemnification: THIS IS A RELEASE OF LIABILITY.** The CCOS student, and the parent/guardian of the CCOS student, knowingly and voluntarily waive, release, exculpate, and discharge The Board of Trustees of the University of Alabama, any foundations affiliated therewith, and their respective trustees, officers, employees, agents, representatives, and volunteers from and against any and all loss, injury, death, claim, action, suit, proceeding, settlement, damages, costs, fees, and expenses, at law or equity, known or unknown, foreseen and unforeseen, including but not limited to attorneys' fees and costs of litigation, and liabilities arising out of, connect with, or resulting from the CCOS student's participation in the IFC recruitment process and any and all events in any way related to Greek life, such as medical expenses, other costs, injury, sickness, and/or death. The CCOS student and her parent/guardian agree to hold harmless and indemnify UA from and against any such liabilities arising from the CCOS student's involvement in the IFC recruitment process and any and all events in any way related to Greek life.

**I, \_\_\_\_\_, acknowledge that I have read and understand this document and its effects on me, and I voluntarily agree to execute this document and participate in any and all IFC recruitment events and, in the event I receive a bid, any and all events in any way related to Fraternity and Sorority Life. I acknowledge that no oral representations, statements, or inducements have been made to me separate and apart from the terms of this document. I voluntarily sign this document of my own free will.**

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CCOS student signature

Date

**I, \_\_\_\_\_, as parent of \_\_\_\_\_, have read and understand this document, and understand the risks associated with my CCOS student's participation in any and all IFC recruitment events and, in the event she receives a bid, any and all events in any way related to Fraternity and Sorority Life. I acknowledge that no oral representations, statements, or inducements have been made to me separate and apart from the terms of this document. I voluntarily sign this document of my own free will.**

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Parent signature

Date

## **CrossingPoints and Alabama Interfraternity Council FAQ**

### **Q: What is CrossingPoints?**

**A:** CrossingPoints is a program for individuals with intellectual disabilities offering three different programs (Tier 1, Tier 2, and Tier 3). Alabama Interfraternity Council will be given the opportunity to work with CrossingPoints' Tier 3 students who are working to earn a Certificate in Occupational Studies (CCOS) at the University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa and who are eligible to participate in recruitment (the CCOS students). The CrossingPoints Certificate in Occupational Studies (CCOS) is a non-degree certificate program for young adults with intellectual disabilities who are interested in pursuing postsecondary education at The University of Alabama. CCOS seeks to provide students with intellectual disabilities with high quality and inclusive college experience.

*\*While CrossingPoints Tier 3 students are certificate-seeking vs. degree-seeking, the University of Alabama does consider them to be fully matriculated.*

**Crossing Points Website:** <https://crossingpoints.ua.edu/>

**Crossing Points Instagram:** @crossingpoints

The Alabama Interfraternity Council and the CrossingPoints coordinators have worked together to create a recruitment experience for the eligible men participants in CrossingPoints. This partnership will provide certain accommodations to IFC policies and procedures to provide a quality experience for the CrossingPoints participants. Other than these accommodations and any need for individual reasonable accommodations, the CrossingPoints men will participate fully in recruitment and if they receive a bid and choose to join an IFC fraternity, they will have benefits of membership.

### **Q: Are CCOS students considered matriculated at UA?**

**A:** Yes, the CCOS students are considered matriculated by UA. Any additional membership eligibility criteria (i.e., GPA, degree-seeking vs. certificate-seeking, etc.) is up to each chapter.

### **Q: Is participation required for all IFC chapters?**

**A:** No. It is up to each member organization to determine whether a CrossingPoints student meets the requirements of membership for that organization (i.e., requirement that students must be degree-seeking, GPA requirement, etc.).

### **Q: Are all CrossingPoints Tier 3 students eligible to join a fraternity or sorority?**

**A:** No, membership will be limited to those CrossingPoints students who have already successfully completed one year of the CrossingPoints program.

### **Q: How many CCOS student PNMs are we able to take in our chapter?**

**A:** IFC will work with the Office of Fraternity and Sorority Life Staff and interested chapters to disperse CCOS students amongst interested IFC chapters, recognizing that it still must be a good for both the CCOS student and the chapter.

**Q: What does membership look like for a CCOS student PNM once he joins a fraternity?**

**A:** CrossingPoints participants can expect to enjoy the privileges of membership in IFC fraternities, including eating meals at the chapter facility (as applicable) and attending philanthropy and brotherhood events. Any requested accommodations, modifications, or limitations will need to be discussed and finalized between the chapter and the new member and his parent/guardians. Additionally, like with other PNMs, the Chapter (and not the University or the CrossingPoints program) is responsible for working with a CrossingPoints student to implement any reasonable accommodations and other necessary supports.

Please note that each chapter has their own membership expectations, including but not limited to: conduct on social media, representation of the chapter, attending meetings, maintaining a specific GPA.

General Cost Information can also be found on the [OFSL Website](#).

**Q: Will the CCOS student's grades be reflect in the overall chapter GPA?**

**A:** Yes. While CrossingPoints Students are non-degree seeking, they are considered fully matriculated by UA and take classes with other UA students.

**Q: Will the CCOS student be held to the same expectations as other members?**

**A:** Yes. However, just as is the case with other members, academic commitments, including commitments related to the CCOS student's participation in the CrossingPoints program including, but not limited to classes, labs, study halls, mandatory program meetings, etc., take precedence over chapter events and should be excused.

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